SIDELINE

An AI sports debate show

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MY PROJECT

A sports debate show, like the ones on TV, but the hosts are AI.

1. You type in a question about the NBA or NFL
2. Three AI hosts argue about it using real stats
3. AI judges pick a winner without knowing who said what

WHY I PICKED IT

I used to watch the sports shows on ESPN when I was younger, and thought it would be cool to try to make one with AI.



HAL BRENNAN

Moderator



ROYCE STANHOPE

Host



DEACON PETTIFORD

Host



LONNIE FAIRWEATHER

Host

HOW IT WORKS

1	CHECK THE QUESTION	Makes sure it’s about the NBA or NFL and current players, and matches each name to a real player. If two players share a name, it asks which one.	**Claude Haiku**
2	FIND STATS	An AI agent asks for the stats it wants, like a quarterback’s playoff record, and the code pulls the real numbers from the data sources.	**Claude Sonnet**
3	DOUBLE-CHECK	Each stat is pulled again from a second source and compared. If they don’t match, it’s thrown out and the agent looks for a replacement.	**Code**
4	WRITE AND CHECK	The script can only use stats that passed. Code checks every number in every line, and another AI reads every claim. Bad lines get rewritten or cut.	**Claude Sonnet and code**
5	JUDGE AND VOICE	Three AI judges score each argument without seeing names, and code adds up the scores. Then every line gets a voice and it plays in the studio.	**Claude Sonnet and Google voices**

A segment takes about 2 minutes to make.

EXAMPLE SEGMENT

“Who is the best quarterback in the NFL?” Starts with the hosts getting ready.
Shortened to 53 seconds.



WHAT I HAD TO MAKE SURE OF

ACCURACY

- I didn’t want the hosts using made-up stats that weren’t real.
- Every stat gets double-checked, and if it can’t be confirmed, it doesn’t get used.
- Every line is checked again after it’s written. Lines with a wrong number get rewritten or cut.
- I tested it by having a stronger AI check every claim in finished scripts. At first 95% were backed up, and by the end it was about 99%.

REALISTIC OPINIONS

- I wanted the hosts to use the eye test, but their opinions still had to be realistic.
- They shouldn’t call a bad 3-point shooter a sharpshooter, or a slow quarterback a dual threat.
- So for each player, it ranks how he plays against others at his position, like how much he runs or how many threes he makes.
- The writer sees that in words. If a line uses a label that doesn’t fit, it gets flagged and rewritten.

FINDING DATA WAS THE HARDEST PART

I wanted to do college football and basketball too, but besides basic stats, almost all of that data is behind a paywall. So I stuck with the NBA and NFL.

SITES I COULDN'T USE (14 TOTAL)

ESPN, because their terms don't allow bots or AI

Pro Football Reference and **Basketball-Reference**, for the same reason

NBA.com and **NFL.com**, which block programs or don't allow collecting their data

Spotrac and **Over The Cap**, so the show has no contract numbers

PFF, which is paid only

WHAT I USED INSTEAD

Sleeper, for stats and rosters

nflverse, for NFL data

muffed.ai, for advanced NFL stats

Wikipedia, for awards and to double-check NBA stats

All of these are free and allow this kind of use.

THANKS!

github.com/IanPierce57/sideline